

COLLINGWOOD PRESS

Author Resource Library

Fiction Manuscript Format Template

A ready-to-use template following the industry-standard manuscript format most editors, agents, and publishers expect for fiction submissions. Replace the placeholder text with your own — the formatting is already done for you.

How to Use This Template

This document is already formatted to standard fiction manuscript submission format. Do not change the font, spacing, or margins below — simply replace the placeholder text with your own on each page.

What's Already Set Up For You

- Font: 12-point Times New Roman throughout
- Line spacing: double-spaced
- Margins: 1 inch on all sides
- Paragraph indents: 0.5 inch first-line indent, no extra space between paragraphs
- Header: Author Last Name / Title / Page Number, starting on the first page of Chapter One
- Chapter headings: centered, positioned about a third of the way down the page
- Scene breaks: a centered # on its own line

Before You Submit

- Replace “Your Name” and “Book Title” on the title page with your actual details
- Update the header on Chapter One with your real last name and title
- Delete this instructions page — it should not be part of your submitted manuscript
- Check your specific agent, editor, or publisher's submission guidelines — most follow this standard, but always confirm word count caps, synopsis requirements, and file format before sending

Need Help Beyond Formatting?

If you'd rather have a professional handle developmental editing, line editing, or full manuscript preparation, Collingwood Press offers all three. Visit **collingwoodpress.com** or reach out at info@collingwoodpress.com — and if you haven't already, grab our free Scam-Proof & Real-Cost Checklist before you sign with any publisher.

Your Name
Street Address
City, State ZIP
Phone Number
email@address.com

Approx. 85,000 words

BOOK TITLE

by
Your Name

Chapter One

Replace this paragraph with the opening line of your story. The first line of a chapter is traditionally not indented in some house styles, but most standard manuscript formatting simply indents every paragraph consistently, including the first — that consistency is what's built into this template already.

Every paragraph below this one will follow the same rule automatically: half-inch first-line indent, double-spaced, no extra blank line between paragraphs. Just keep typing the way you would in any word processor and the formatting will carry through.

When you want a scene break within a chapter — a jump in time, location, or point of view — center a single number sign on its own line, the way it appears below.

#

Resume your next scene here, indented and double-spaced exactly as before. When you're ready to begin Chapter Two, insert a page break and center a new chapter heading a third of the way down the page, exactly as Chapter One appears above.

Delete all of this placeholder text before you begin writing — everything above exists only to show you how the formatting behaves once real text is in place.